Tech Scout — 16 Oct 2026

SHOOT DAY 26 OCT 2026 · TWO SETS · DIRECTOR, DP, GAFFER, KEY GRIP, CAM OP, 1st AD, VIDEO ASSIST

LOCKED — PLEASE DON'T RE-OPEN THESE ON SITE

Pad	202.8 × 81.0 ft. Measured off the Google Maps scale bar, corroborated by the slab's 2.4:1 aspect.
Orientation	**Page up on the plate is 332° true (NNW), not north.** Cameras look NNW. Measured two ways, agree within 1.5°.
Sun, 26 Oct	Rise 06:23 · solar noon 12:09 at 59.0° · set 17:56 AST. Azimuth verified to 0.005°.
Key direction	Sun is **camera left all afternoon** (−101° at 14:30 → −77° at 17:30). Never flips, so both sets cut together.
Cam A throw	35 mm full frame needs **35 ft** to cover the band. On Super 35 the same frame needs ~48 ft, which is into the road.
Light level	Only −0.44 stops from 14:30 to 16:30. Then −0.81 by 17:00 and −1.77 by 17:30.

DP RECOMMENDATIONS I'M BRINGING TO THE SCOUT

1 · No 20×20. At 14:30 a four-hi-roller rig covers 13.2 ft; the compressed band needs 13.5. Short by inches, and it is 400 sq ft of sail on an open pad in October trades for one hour of coverage. The geometry only closes with a 24.6 ft top rail raked 30° — that's a condor, not a grip stand.
Instead: shoot the natural side light; 12×12 ultrabounce camera right to pull the ratio from ~8:1 to 3–4:1; 12×12 diffusion reserved for Cam B / C close-ups, where one person at a time is trivially covered.

2 · Swap the running order. The band is the wide subject and needs the low sun; the duo is narrow and doesn't. As scheduled it's inverted. Band at 16:30 removes the diffusion problem entirely. **Cost: band loads out at dusk.** AD's call.

WHAT WE MUST WALK OUT KNOWING

#	DEPT	QUESTION	WHY IT MATTERS
1	Gaffer / AD	**Where does power come from?** Panel at the park, the shelter, or a genny?	Band rider alone is ~2–4 kW of audio before a single light. Two dedicated 20 A circuits minimum.
2	Gaffer / DP	Stand at the band position and look **west** — how high is the treeline, how far?	Trees west/NW will shadow the pad at 12–25° sun. The real out-time, not 17:56.
3	Key Grip	Wind at the band position. Feel it at both set times.	Decides whether any frame flies at all. This is the gating item, not the geometry.
4	Key Grip	Can we get stands and sandbags onto the pad? Where's the ballast coming from?	Load path and the curb lip at the pad edge.
5	Cam Op	Is there **35 ft of clear, level ground** south of the pad for Cam A?	The whole 35 mm wide depends on it. Check for the curb, road and parked cars.
6	Cam Op / VA	Cable run distances from A, B and C back to village.	Video assist spec and cable order.
7	VA / AD	Where is video village? Needs shade and power.	No shade anywhere near the camera positions.
8	1st AD	Can the running order swap (band late, duo early)? Band load-in / out path and times, park access, permits, other users, lock-up.	See recommendation 2. If we swap, the band strikes at dusk and needs work lights.
9	DP / Dir	**Stake both footprints with the real backline.** Band ≤ 14 ft? Duo ≤ 12 ft?	Every lighting number downstream assumes them. 4.5 ft per player across the band's front line.

TIMING ON SITE TODAY — TODAY'S LIGHT RUNS ~15 MIN AHEAD OF SHOOT DAY

14:15 today	= shoot-day 14:30. Sun 43.5°, camera left.
15:15 today	= shoot-day 15:30. Sun 31.6°, clean 90° side.
16:15 today	= shoot-day 16:30. Sun 18.7°, raking.
16:50 today	= shoot-day 17:00. **Treeline check.**

Bring / do:

- Tape measure — stake the 14 ft band box and the Cam A position
- Meter the key-to-shadow ratio at 14:15 and 16:15
- Reference stills at both times, same lens, for the director
- Photograph the western treeline from the band position
- Find the power tie-in or confirm we're on a genny

Grip & Gaffer Package

FOR SCOUT DISCUSSION · REV 1, 16 OCT 2026

> **The number that drives this list.** At 14:30 the sun delivers about **8,700 fc**. A 1.2k HMI through a 6×6 at 6 ft delivers about **167 fc** — **5.7 stops under**. No unit in a 1-ton package keys against that sun. So for Set 1 the sun *is* the key and we shape it with bounce; the 1.2k's real job is Set 2, after the sun leaves. Levels are order-of-magnitude from luminous flux and inverse square — check against the head's own photometric chart.

DESIGN INTENT

SET 1 · BAND · hard side sun	**Key = the sun**, camera left, 43.5°→31.6°. It is the only source even across 14 ft. Fill the shadow side with bounce to ~4:1. Put a low bounce under the frame line to get light into eyes under the cap brims — that is the real problem at 43°, not the ratio.
SET 2 · DUO · sun leaving	**16:30–17:00 natural** — raking key camera left at 18.7°→12°, bounce right for fill. This is the best light of the day; front-load hero coverage. **17:00–17:15 crossover. 17:15 on: 1.2k through 6×6**, camera left at the sun's departing angle so the key direction does not change on the cut. Backlight for separation once the sky goes flat.

GRIP

QTY	ITEM	PURPOSE
2	**8×8 frame + ultrabounce**	Set 1 fill, camera right, just outside the frustum, in full sun. Two 8×8s beat one 12×12 here — half the sail each and they cover the 14 ft width evenly.
1	**12×12 frame + ultrabounce**	Set 2 fill. Can be struck and re-skinned for the key at crossover.
1	**6×6 frame + 1/4 grid**	Set 2 key diffusion for the 1.2k. Small frame on purpose — it gets close, and proximity is what buys the level.
1	**4×4 ultrabounce + turtle base**	**Eye light.** Low and centred, just under frame. Kills the cap-brim shadow. Cheapest fix on the list.
2	**4×4 floppy**	Flare control. Sun is a 90° side all afternoon — lens flare is a live risk on the camera-left side of every setup.
4	**Hi-roller stands**	Frames. No 20×20 — see the scout brief.
6	**Combo stands**	Frames, heads.
8	**C-stands + arms**	Flags, floppies, the 4×4.
40	**Sandbags**	**Minimum.** Open concrete pad, October trades, nothing to tie to. This is the number I will not negotiate down.
—	**Ratchet straps / tie-downs**	Frames. Bags alone are not enough if it gusts.
—	**Apple boxes, wedges, cribbing**	Pad edges are not level; stands need levelling at the curb lip.
—	**Carpet / neg fill**	**Targeted, not blanket.** Lay it where concrete bounce reads in frame and in the background. Do *not* carpet under the band at 43° sun — that uplight is what is saving the eyes.

ELECTRIC

QTY	ITEM	PURPOSE
1	**1.2k HMI + ballast + head cable**	**Have it.** Set 2 key from ~17:15. Not a Set 1 unit.
1	**Second head — 1.2k or 600 W LED COB (ASK)**	Backlight / separation for the duo once the sky flattens. This is what makes Set 2 look built rather than merely exposed. Biggest single upgrade to the package.
—	**Gel: 1/4 + 1/2 CTO, 1/4 CTB, ND3 / ND6**	The sun warms hard as it drops. The HMI has to chase it or the cut will not match.
—	**Stingers, 100 ft runs, distro**	Camera positions are ~28 ft off the pad; village further.
2	**Work lights / balloon**	Band load-out at dusk if the running order swaps.

POWER

LOAD	W	A
1.2k HMI + ballast	**1400**	**14**
Second head	**1400**	**14**
Band audio — ESTIMATE	**2500**	**25**
Village, monitors, chargers	**500**	**5**
TOTAL	**5800**	**58**

Paper amps at 120 V (W/100). Band figure is my estimate from the rider and must be confirmed by sound.

> **10–12 kW tow plant.** 5.8 kW running, but HMI ballasts surge to roughly 2× at strike — size for the strike, not the run. Never run a plant continuously under 20% of capacity.
>
> **Keep the HMI off the audio supply.** Ballast noise into a PA is a classic and it will not be fixable in post. Separate putt-putt for sound, or separate legs at minimum, and sound gets the say.

OPEN: band audio draw · whether a second head is in budget · generator vs. park service · confirmed band and duo footprints.

VEGA BAJA SKATE PARK

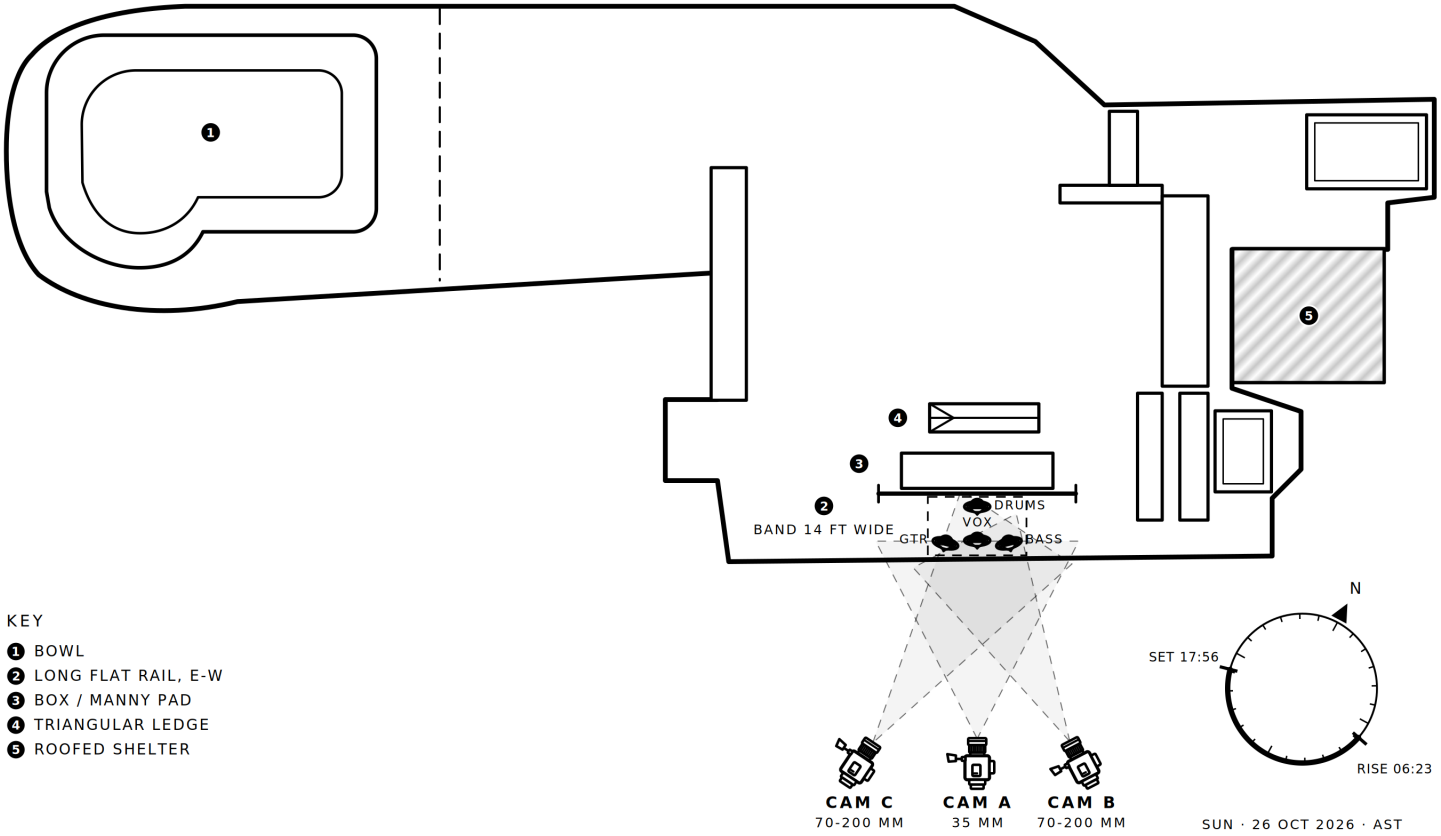
OVERHEAD LAYOUT BASE · PAGE UP = 332° (NNW)

CORRE FORREST! · SHOOT 26 OCT 2026

REV 6 · 16 OCT 2026

CAMERAS

A	35 MM	BAND WIDE / CENTRE
B	70-200 MM	CLOSE / VOCALS
C	70-200 MM	CLOSE / INSTRUMENTS



KEY

1. BOWL
2. LONG FLAT RAIL, E-W
3. BOX / MANNY PAD
4. TRIANGULAR LEDGE
5. ROOFED SHELTER

SUN · 26 OCT 2026 · AST

0 25 50 75 FEET

PAD 202.8 ft × 81.0 ft · SCALE FROM GOOGLE MAPS BAR